

Natural History





About the Course

Students learn to observe a variety of creatures through their Nature Reader, including insects, insect larvae, mammals, and some aquatic species. Coordinating afternoon activities are provided in Outdoor Work.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Grade 2

About Science: Grade 2

In level 2, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and slightly more abstract concepts.

Science: Grade 2

The Big Picture:

To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Form 1 learners in grades 1-3 are at the beginning of this relationship: developing familiarity and friendship with Creation. Their sense of community is primarily focused on their immediate environment at this stage, but they are curious about others. The familiarity with foundational knowledge grown and nurtured in Form 1 prepares them for greater curiosity and personal interest in Form 2.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just 'feels right.' Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Literature Grades 1-3).



Placement & Combining Tips

About Science: Grade 2

In level 2, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and slightly more abstract concepts.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2	Natural History: Grade 2 1 time/week 10 min	Walks with a Naturalist: Living Nature Reader Volume 2

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Grade 2				
General Science: Grade 2				



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Science: Grade 2

- ☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
- ☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:

- ☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
- ☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Special Topics & Field Trips

Science: Grade 2

- ☐ Learn a few of your local species on these special topics using the internet, field guides, or your local nature preserve, conservancy, or state/national park.
- ☐ Note whether there are particular locations nearby for the student to easily notice the special topics on walks or during afternoon occupations.

Natural History: Grade 2

- Term 1: insects, especially larvae, and trees
- Term 2: animal sign, twigs, marine creatures
- Term 3: insects, birds, spring ephemerals

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Science: Grade 2

Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons, as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term:

Natural History: Grade 2

- ☐ Term 1: insects p.294-300, trees p.618-623
- ☐ Term 2: tree winter work p.624, choose 1-2 mammals from p.214-293
- ☐ Term 3: wildflower intro and 1-2 spring ephemerals from p.460-487, aquatic insects and dragonflies p.400-408



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Natural History: Grade 2



Walks with a Naturalist: Living Nature Reader Volume 2



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Natural History: Grade 2

How To Teach



Introduce

- Begin each lesson with learners' existing knowledge. If the book or activity is new or unfamiliar, then look at the title, a picture, or guidance in the lesson plan to help discuss what students think, drawing on previous experience. If continuing or revisiting a topic or activity, then recap. The lesson plans often help with this.
- Some learners may benefit from using pictures or looking back briefly.
- Allow them time to share any concerns and come alongside, as needed.



Complete

- Read, or do, as instructed in the lessons, noting any Teacher Tips provided. Learners should always have their nature journal or some other notebook/paper available in case they need to draw or diagram during the lesson.
- When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- If learners do not understand a word or concept, do not worry. Try to show them with a picture or connect the idea to something they have seen in real life. They are learning much by the way and will likely build understanding over the term, the year, or beyond.



Narrate

- Process the ideas of the lesson by retelling the events in sequence, describing a scene or setting, explaining a concept, etc.
- Learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.



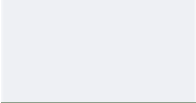
Discuss

- Consider together any thoughts, confusion, or concerns about the passage.
- Questions/topics for further discussion are often provided in the lesson plans to help. There are no right or wrong answers to these. If teachers want to keep ideas active in the mind, these can also be used at other times to keep the ideas in the working memory.



Connect

- Follow any extra links, examine any sidebars in the text, look at pictures, etc., depending on learner interest.

- 
- These can also be viewed as alternative ways to engage.
-

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 1

Night Visitors

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

What do you recall about insects? Briefly share in word or picture. Our naturalist friend, Melissa, is going to introduce us to some of the creatures she sees after dark. Look at the picture on p.1. Have you ever seen such a brightly painted moth? Who else do you think we might meet after dark?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-5 "One summer night" - "after dark?"

Read the definitions and notes at the end of each reading, as desired.

- What have you seen or heard when you've been outside after dark? Tell what you have noticed.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: 7 Spectacular Moths in Slow Motion (5:23)

∞ Video Link: Why moths are obsessed with lamps (2:06)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

★ TEACHER NOTE

The second video is from an evolutionary perspective. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way, provide additional commentary, or skip this one.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 2

Caterpillar Hunting

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me about some of the creatures we met last week. All of those creatures were adults, the grown up animal. Today we're going to look for some baby insects, called caterpillars. Have you ever found a caterpillar? Briefly tell what you noticed.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-9 "One afternoon" - "a caterpillar?"

- The caterpillars that Melissa found hatched from eggs and would someday turn into adult moths. Draw each of these stages on separate index cards or pieces of paper. Can you put them in order? Which comes first, middle, or last in the life of the insect? (egg -> caterpillar/larva -> adult/moth) Keep these in your book for next week!

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

★ TEACHER TIP

If students need support drawing or diagramming, the teacher may do any activities with them in tandem or act as their scribe.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- ∞ Video Link: Luna Moth (1:39)
- ∞ Video Link: Ceanothus Silk Moth (0:38), a West Coast moth sometimes confused for a luna

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 3

My Pet Spike

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what you recall from our last reading. The caterpillar begins life as an egg and turns into a moth or butterfly. Today we're going to read about another caterpillar - up close!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-16 "One summer" - "life cycle!"

- Last week we ordered egg -> caterpillar -> moth. Did you notice the step we missed in this week's reading? Draw the pupa and add it to your collection. Where does it go? (egg -> caterpillar/larva -> pupa -> adult/moth)

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Watch this caterpillar turn into a moth! (3:36)

★ TEACHER TIP

Notice that any prompt to recall or think about can be done verbally, in picture, or in any other way that suits the student(s). Apply this flexibility to all lessons.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 4

How do caterpillars stay safe?

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember about caterpillars. Look at the picture on p.18. What do you notice? Many birds love to eat caterpillars, so caterpillars need many ways to avoid being eaten! That's what we're going to learn about today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-21 "I squeal" - "being eaten!"

- Think of a caterpillar you have seen. How was it trying to stay safe?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Caterpillars Hiding in Plain Sight (2:30)
- ∞ Video Link: Tips for finding caterpillars (3:43)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 5

Slug Caterpillars

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about last week. Look at the picture on p.23. What do you notice? Does that look like a caterpillar? Let's read about this very strange group of caterpillars.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.23-26 "One of my" - "they eating?"

- Have you ever seen a strange caterpillar that might have been a slug caterpillar? Tell about it.
- Which of these caterpillars would you like to meet? What would you hope to observe?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Caterpillars are the BEST! (9:27)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 6

Tagging Monarchs

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember about caterpillars. Some caterpillars turn into moths, but others turn into butterflies. Look at the picture on p.27. What do you notice?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.27-31 "I see" - "amazing migration!"

- Compare the picture of the butterfly on p.27 with that of the moth on p.1. How are they similar or different?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: How to Hold a Butterfly (4:16)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 7

Acorn Weevils

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

What do you remember from our last reading? Look at the picture of the

★ TEACHER NOTE

It can sometimes be unnerving for students not to get an immediate answer to a question. Encourage them to sit with big questions, like the one in today's suggested discussion, while they continue to make observations.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

acorn on p.33. What is going on with that acorn?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-35 "Our backyard" - "those holes!"

- Compare the stages in the life of the acorn weevil with those of the caterpillar. Are they the same? Do you think other insects follow this pattern? How could you find out?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Weevil Drilling an Acorn w/o narration (0:46)

∞ Video Link: This Weevil w/close up & narration (5:46)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 8

Me and My Magnifier

📄 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

What did we read about last week? Let's turn to the leaves of the trees today and see what we can learn.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.36-38 "I always carry" - "you notice?"

- Have you ever used a magnifier? What did you look at? What did you notice? What did it remind you of? What did you wonder about?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Leaves Magnified (3:59)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 9 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 9

Red Oak, White Oak

📄 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Recall what we read about last week. Today, Melissa is going to show us how much she notices when she compares 2 trees. You might want to make a drawing or diagram as we read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-42 "Behind our house" - "is different?"

- Are there 2 trees that you would like to compare? Where are they?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Observation of Leaves (6:05)

★ TEACHER TIP

Because this passage is a description instead of a series of dependent events, building a diagram while reading can help to create a picture in the mind. If students need support, the teacher may do the activity with them in tandem or as a scribe.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 10 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 10

How to Survive the Winter, Butterfly Style

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Recall what we read last. Do you remember how the acorn weevil and Melissa's pet Spike spent the winter? The larva buries itself in the soil and spends the winter as a pupa, but just like different creatures have different ways of staying safe, different creatures have different ways of getting through the cold winter. Look at the picture on p.43. This butterfly is getting ready for winter, too. What do you notice?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-45 "A few days" - "the winter?"

- Isn't it awesome how each creature has everything it needs in its home? Think of any creature you like and consider how it gets food, shelter, and safety. Read Matthew 6:26-27, if desired.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Silvery Checkerspot Laying Eggs (2:34)

∞ Video Link: Monarch Butterfly Laying Eggs (0:52)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 11

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons, watch some videos that you didn't have time for, or discuss some interesting ideas over a snack. Depending on your discussions, these MIGHT include:

- What do you recall about caterpillars?
- Tell about the stages in the life of many insects.
- Tell about leaves or nuts.
- Compare how different insects overwinter.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 12 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Walks with a Naturalist 2

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 13

A Monarch's Migration

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Do you remember the caterpillars we learned about last term? Tell me about someone you remember. How do you think those creatures survive the winter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.47-52 "In 'How'" - "to or from?"

Read the notes and definitions at the end of each reading, as desired.

- Are you still noticing butterflies? If so, what were they doing? How do you think they are getting ready for winter?
- Are you noticing animals that are very busy or that haven't been around all summer? Tell what they have been doing.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Monarch Butterfly Rest Stop (4:34)

∞ Video Link: Western Monarch Butterfly (3:51)

∞ Image Link: Monarch Migration Map

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 14

Monarch Magic

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember about the monarch butterfly. Have you ever gone on a long trip, like the monarch? Melissa is going to take us to Mexico with her today, so that we can visit all of those monarchs that traveled for the winter.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.53-56 "Last winter" - "magical moment!"

- Imagine what it would be like to be at a monarch overwintering site. How would you explore it with sight, hearing, touch, and smell?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Monarch Butterfly Swarm (3:07)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 15

A Whale of a Trip

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read last week. What else do you think we can see in Mexico? Look at the picture on p.57. Do you know what that is?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.57-60 "In 'Monarch' - "nature journal!"

- What is the biggest animal you've ever seen? Where does it live?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Humpback Whale Breaching (1:13)
- ∞ Video Link: What are barnacles? (0:55)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 16

Swash Riders

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember from our last lesson. Have you ever visited the ocean? If so, tell what you noticed. If not, tell what you would like to notice if you go there someday. Look at the picture on p.62. What do you notice about these shells?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.62-65 "When I visit" - "can observe!"

- A seashell is a home for an animal! How many different animals can you think of that carry their homes around with them? (clams, snails, hermit crabs, turtles, etc.) Would you like to carry your home around with you? Why or why not?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Coquina Clams (0:42)
- ∞ Video Link: How are Seashells Made? (4:28)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 17

Beach Treasures

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Tell me what you recall from our last reading. What else can you find on the beach? Look at the picture on p.66. What do you notice?

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.66-70 "Taking a walk" - "nature walk?"

- Tell about your favorite place to walk - a place that seems filled with treasures.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Sand Dollar (4:22)
- ∞ Video Link: Stingrays & Skates (0:23)
- ∞ Video Link: Jellies 101 (2:47)

discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 18

Tracks in the Snow

📄 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Recall what we've been reading about. Now it's time to leave the ocean and explore the snowy parts of our home. Do you get snow where you live? Look at the picture on p.71. What do you notice in this picture? Have you seen wild animals that live in snowy habitats? Let's go looking for one today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-74 "Back in North" - "muddy areas!"

- Sometimes when we're on a walk or working on a puzzle, there seems to be a mess of pieces, and it's hard to see how they fit together. Have you ever experienced that? Do you think that's how Melissa felt when she was trying to understand the tracks through the snow? What do you do in such a situation?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Ermine in the Snow (0:10)
- ∞ Video Link: Track Patterns (3:38)

★ TEACHER TIP

It can sometimes be unnerving for students to not get an immediate answer to a question, so encourage them to sit with big questions, like the one in today's suggested discussion, while they continue to make observations.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 19

Antlers versus Horns

📄 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about last time. Tracks are one way that we can learn about a creature, even if we don't get to see it. Can you think of other signs that animals might leave behind after they've left? (scat, remains of food, nesting material, antlers, etc.) Look at the picture on p.76. What are those? What do you notice?

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.76-79 "When my nephew" - "in the woods?"

- What animals have antlers or horns where you live?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: North America's Deer (0:52)
- ∞ Video Link: Bull Moose Shedding its Antlers (1:18)
- ∞ Video Link: Bighorn Sheep (0:12)
- ∞ Video Link: Mountain Goat (0:59)

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 20

A Plant that Bites Back

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

We've been visiting some different places and learning about different creatures this term. Tell me about one or two that you remember. One place that a lot of people don't think about visiting is a swamp. Have you ever been to a swamp? What do you think of when you hear that word? Let's visit a swamp with Melissa today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.80-82 "I like to" - "can discover!"

- Think about a plant that you enjoy. Tell what makes that plant friend interesting to you!

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Venus Fly Traps Can Count (1:44)
- ∞ Website Link: Interesting Native Plants. Most plants have something interesting once you get to know them, but here are a few images with short descriptions for inspiration.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 9 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 21

Night in a Blind

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Tell what you remember from our last reading. Look at the picture on p.84. Have you ever seen a bird like this? What do you notice about the bird?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.84-88 "One March" - "never forget!"

- Do the birds at home act differently when they can see you and when they don't know you are there? Tell what you've noticed.

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is an old earth reference at 2:48 in the video. Teachers might choose to allow it to pass by the way, provide additional commentary, or skip this one.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Sandhill Cranes (4:56)
- ∞ Image Link: Simple Bird Blind

WEEK 10 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 22

A Swamp Paddle

📖 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Recall what we read about last week. Today let's see what other creatures we can find in Melissa's canoe.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.89-94 "In April" - "you all?"

- Tell about a place you have enjoyed exploring. What new nature friends did you meet there?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Mingo Swamp, Missouri (6:34)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 23

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons, watch some videos that you didn't have time for, or discuss some interesting ideas over a snack. Depending on your discussions, these MIGHT include:

- Recall different ways that moths and butterflies overwinter (as egg, pupa, migrating adult).
- Recall different places we 'visited' (Mexico, seaside, swamp).
- Tell about the variety of different creatures at the seaside.
- Consider the different signs that animals leave behind and that help us learn about them (tracks, antlers, their homes, etc).
- Recall the Things we treasure and nature friends we've met.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 12 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Walks with a Naturalist 2

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 25

The Bear Woods

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

Do you remember when Melissa tracked the ermine in the snow last term? Tell me what you remember. Spring is a really great time to notice animal tracks. Why do you think that is? (mud, animals becoming more active, etc.) Let's listen to find out about many different ways we can notice animals even when we might not get to see them.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.95-99 "Mike and I" - "leave behind!"

- Do you leave signs behind when you go outside? What kinds of signs do you think you leave? Have you ever walked in the mud? What did your footprints look like?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Studying Individual Tracks (3:39)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 2 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 26

Barking up the Right Tree

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Recall what we read last time. There is a very interesting creature that you might observe when you are outside. It often grows on trees and rocks. Have you ever heard of lichen? Let's find out about this strange nature find today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.100-102 "There are lots" - "your magnifier?"

- What do you notice about the lichen in the picture on p.101? What do you wonder about? Does it remind you of anything?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Website Link: Lichens Photo Gallery

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 3 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 27

Plant Time Machine

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Remind me what we've been reading about. Today we're going to be

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

thinking about the plants that are starting to grow and how we can get to know them better. Look at the picture on p.104. What do you notice in this picture?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.104-108 "In the spring" - "grow and change?"

- What plants have you been noticing outside? Are they growing? Have you noticed similar plants with and without flowers? Tell what you have seen.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Yellow Trout Lily (2:22)

∞ Website Link: Gallery of Fawn (Trout) Lilies Across North America

WEEK 4 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 28

A Bee Mystery

📄 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about last time. Look at the picture on p.110. Tell what you notice about this creature. Is it an insect? How do you know?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.110-113 "One afternoon" - "can observe!"

- How do you feel about bees when you see them on a walk or when you play outside? Do they seem to notice you, or do they seem to be doing their business?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Cellophane Bees (1:26)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 5 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 29

Bird Banding Part 1

📄 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

We have been learning about many signs of spring. Tell me about one or two that you remember. What do you recall about the cellophane bee? Look at the picture on p.115. What do you notice about this bird?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.115-118 "When I first" - "banding station."

- Have you ever held a bird before? If so, what did it feel like? What did you notice? If not, tell about a bird that you would like to know better.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Bird Banding (to 1:20)
- ∞ Video Link: Hooded Warbler (0:11)

WEEK 6 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 30

Bird Banding Part 2

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

PREP: Read Teacher Tip

→ INTRO

In the last passage, we learned a bit about bird banding. Tell what you remember. Let's listen to the rest of this story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.119-123 "At the banding" - "your bird!"

- Tell about birds that you have noticed this week.

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Bird Banding (1:21-3:22)

★ TEACHER TIP

Supplemental links for optional support are provided at the END of the lesson. They can be used at any point to help generate interest during the introduction, to enliven the lesson itself, or to add to discussion later. They are NOT required and should NOT take away from the narration and discussion. Experiment and see what works best for your student(s).

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 7 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 31

Froggy Lullaby

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Tell me about our last reading. Look at the picture on p.124. What do you notice? What do you wonder about?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.124-127 "At our house" - "nighttime sounds!"

- Can you sing like a frog that you have heard? Give it a try!

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

- ∞ Video Link: Some Frog Calls (1:24)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 8 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 32

Dragonfly Swarm

Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Tell me what you remember from our last reading. Look at the picture on p.128. What do you notice? Today, we're noticing the dragonfly, an insect we might see living alongside frogs and other creatures that like wet habitats.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The supplemental video mentions the age of the Earth at 3:34. Teachers might want to allow it to pass by the way, consider how they would like to discuss, stop the video early, or skip this one.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.128-131 "One day - "they're up to!"

- If you were a superhero called The Dragonfly, what would be your superpower?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: How do dragonflies see the world? (4:13)

time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 9 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 33

Dobsonflies and Hellgrammites

📄 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Tell me what you recall from our last reading. Look at the picture on p.132. What do you notice? What do you think this might be?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.132-136 "On a walk" - "surprise you?"

- Do big insects scare you when you are outside? Do you think that learning about them helps you feel less scared? Is there anything else that helps?

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

∞ Video Link: Male Dobsonfly (1:47)

∞ Video Link: Hellgrammites (1:08)

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 10 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 34

Flying Blue Toothpicks

📄 Materials: Walks with a Naturalist 2

→ INTRO

Remind me what we read about in our last reading. What do you remember about the dragonflies from the previous week? The larvae of dragonflies and their cousins, damselflies, live in the water, too. Look at the picture on p.137. What do you notice about the damselfly larva? Today we'll read about damselflies and their life cycle.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.137-139 "When I was" - "an exuvia!"

- Compare the life cycle of damselflies to that of butterflies or dobsonflies. What stages does the damselfly have in its life cycle? In what sequence do they occur? (egg -> larva/nymph -> adult) Dragonflies have a similar life cycle to the damselfly. What do you recall about the butterfly or dobsonfly? (egg -> larva -> pupa -> adult)

→ SUPPLEMENTAL

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- ∞ Video Link: Damselflies (2:31)
- ∞ Video Link: Damselfly Emergence (1:28)
- ∞ Video Link: Dragonfly or Damselfly? (0:56)
- ∞ Video Link: Green Lacewing (0:32)

WEEK 11 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 35

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons, watch some videos that you didn't have time for, or discuss some interesting ideas over a snack. Depending on your discussions, these MIGHT include:

- Consider the different signs that animals leave behind and that help us learn about them (tracks, scat, their homes, etc).
- Think about what kinds of observations are helpful to notice about individual tracks.
- Tell about signs of spring (birds, plants in various stages of growth, native bees and other early insects, etc).
- Tell what you recall about lichen.
- Tell about frogs and pond insects.
- Compare the life cycle of damselflies or dragonflies and that of butterflies or dobsonflies.

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

WEEK 12 10m Natural History: Grade 2 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Walks with a Naturalist 2

• OUTDOOR WORK

Weekly walks and daily outdoor time are vital! Resources in Quick Links.

Natural History: Grade 2

Examination

- Term 1** · Walks with a Naturalist 2: Tell about or draw a caterpillar. OR Tell about or draw a leaf or tree nut.
- Term 2** · Walks with a Naturalist 2: Tell about or draw the ways that insects overwinter. OR Tell about or draw a creature that lives in an unfamiliar habitat, such as the seaside or swamp.
- Term 3** · Walks with a Naturalist 2: Tell about or draw signs that animals leave behind. OR Compare using words or pictures the life cycle of a moth with that of the damselfly.